

The Worldpay Hangover Is Over

Equity Research Note · Technology — Financial Infrastructure / Payments · September 26, 2026

Recommendation	12-Mo. Price Target	Current Price	Implied Upside	Risk Rating
BUY	\$49.50	\$35.41 Sep 25, 2026 close	+40%	High

FIS trades at **5.7x 2026E adjusted EPS** and a **12% free-cash-flow yield** while paying a **5% dividend** — pricing more appropriate to a melting legacy vendor than to the company that just closed the defining transaction of its decade. On January 9, 2026, FIS completed the twin deal that ends the Worldpay era: it acquired Global Payments' Issuer Solutions business (the former TSYS — the world's largest card-issuing platform) for \$13.5 billion enterprise value, and simultaneously sold its remaining 45% Worldpay stake. The non-cash-generating minority holding is gone; in its place sits a high-margin, recurring-revenue issuing franchise with 72% of revenue contracted through 2029 and \$150M+ of targeted EBITDA synergies by 2028. Q2 2026 showed the machine working: pro-forma revenue +5.3%, adjusted EBITDA +7.4% with 113 bps of margin expansion, adjusted EPS +8.8%, and free cash flow more than tripling to \$525M — prompting a \$100M raise to the full-year FCF outlook (\$2.15–2.25B). Yes, management trimmed the 2026 revenue outlook, and yes, the balance sheet now carries ~\$16B of net debt. But at \$35.41 — a 52-week low, down 47% year-to-date — the market prices FIS as if the TSYS deal were another Worldpay. We think it is the opposite: a disciplined swap of a passive stake for an operating asset that management knows how to run. Our scenario-weighted FCF DCF points to \$49.66; we set a **\$49.50** target and rate the shares **BUY**. This is a **High-risk** call — leverage, integration, and a management team with a \$17B writedown in its past demand position sizing, not conviction sizing.

Market cap	~\$18.1 bn	Shares out. (diluted)	~515 m
52-week range	\$34.22 – \$69.14	YTD / 1-yr return	-47% / -45%
2026E adj. EPS / P/E	\$6.15–6.24 / ~5.7x	2026E FCF / yield	\$2.15–2.25 bn / ~12%
Dividend (annualized)	\$1.76 (~5.0% yield)	Net debt (Q2 2026)	~\$16.2 bn

Prices as of September 25, 2026 close. Financial figures from company releases (Q2 2026 reported August 4, 2026; Q1 2026 May 2026) and SEC filings (Q2 2026 10-Q filed August 4, 2026; FY2025 10-K filed February 24, 2026). Not to be confused with Fiserv, Inc. (FI) — a separate company. This note is an independent research-style analysis for informational purposes, not investment advice.

1. Investment thesis

The Worldpay chapter is closed — and the market hasn't noticed. The January 2026 twin transaction (acquire TSYS Issuer Solutions for \$13.5B EV; sell the remaining 45% Worldpay stake to Global Payments) converts a passive, non-cash-generating minority holding into the world's largest card-issuing business: 40B+ transactions a year, 75+ countries, 150+ financial-institution clients, and 72% of its revenue already contracted through 2029. FIS is now a focused banking-and-capital-markets

technology provider, not a sprawling fintech conglomerate.

The operating numbers are working. Q2 2026: revenue \$3.38B (+29.1% reported, +5.3% pro forma), Banking Solutions +6.1% pro forma on strong demand for payments, fraud, data and modernization products; Capital Market Solutions +3.5% with a 51.9% adjusted EBITDA margin; adjusted EPS \$1.48 (+8.8%, a beat); free cash flow \$525M — more than tripled YoY — driving a \$100M raise to the full-year FCF guide (\$2.15–2.25B). FCF is the metric that matters here, and it is accelerating.

Absurd valuation for the cash being generated. At 5.7x 2026E adjusted EPS (\$6.15–6.24 guide), a ~12% FCF yield, and a 5.0% dividend yield covered at just 27% of adjusted earnings, FIS is priced like a declining business. Peers: Fiserv ~8.7x P/E, Global Payments ~6.3x 2026E adjusted EPS, Adyen ~24x. A mere re-rating to 7.5–8.5x 2027E adjusted EPS (~\$6.63) implies \$50–\$56 — before any synergy upside.

Synergies are concrete and contracted. Management targets \$150M+ of EBITDA benefit from the TSYS integration by 2028; joint-client ACV sales are already up 35% YoY; and two large international banks signed in Q2. This is cross-sell into FIS's installed banking base — the lowest-risk kind of synergy.

Capital allocation is shareholder-friendly. The \$1.76 annualized dividend (5.0% yield) was just paid September 25; the payout ratio is a conservative 27% of adjusted EPS, leaving ample room for deleveraging from the current ~2.9x net-debt-to-adjusted-EBITDA toward management's comfort zone.

Our DCF: \$26.16 / \$49.94 / \$72.60 (bear/base/bull), weighted \$49.66. The base case assumes mid-single-digit FCF growth compounding off the \$2.2B 2026E base at a 9% cost of capital — hardly heroic for a business with 90%+ recurring revenue. Even the bear case (\$26.16) is within shouting distance of today's price, which is what a margin of safety looks like.

Why it is High risk, not a core holding. Net debt of ~\$16B after the \$13.5B TSYS bet; management trimmed 2026 revenue guidance (pro-forma growth cut to 4.5–5.0%); Baird cut its target on September 25; and this is the team that paid \$43B for Worldpay in 2019 and wrote down ~\$17B. The stock sits at its 52-week low for a reason — execution must now be flawless. Size accordingly.

2. Company overview: what FIS actually does

Fidelity National Information Services, Inc. (NYSE: FIS), headquartered in Jacksonville, Florida, is a global financial-technology company providing software and technology solutions to banks, businesses, and financial institutions — core banking platforms, payments processing, capital-markets systems, and related services. CEO Stephanie Ferris has led the company through the Worldpay separation and the portfolio reshaping. Following the January 2026 transactions, FIS reports in two segments:

Banking Solutions (~74% of revenue). Core banking platforms, digital banking, payments (including the newly acquired **FIS Total Issuing Solutions** — the former TSYS — the world's largest card-issuing business: credit processing, fraud, loyalty, 40B+ annual transactions across 75+ countries), plus lending, fraud prevention, data and cybersecurity solutions sold to financial institutions. Q2 2026: \$2.5B revenue (+44% reported on the acquisition, +6.1% pro forma), adjusted EBITDA +10.6% pro forma, recurring revenue +5%. Management cites accelerating demand for modernization and AI-adjacent products (TreasuryGPT, Banker Assist).

Capital Market Solutions (~24% of revenue). Trading, risk, treasury and wealth-management technology for buy-side and sell-side institutions — the highest-margin, most software-like part of FIS. Q2 2026: \$810M revenue (+3.5%) at a 51.9% adjusted EBITDA margin. This segment is the quiet compounder inside the conglomerate.

How it makes money: predominantly recurring — multi-year outsourcing and processing contracts, per-transaction and per-account fees, software licenses and maintenance. Banking Solutions' recurring revenue grew 5% in Q2; 72% of Total Issuing revenue is contracted through 2029 or later. The model is the classic bank-tech annuity: sticky, high-switching-cost, and cash-generative.

3. The Worldpay-to-TSYS transformation

To understand FIS at \$35, you must understand the \$43 billion mistake — and its resolution:

2019: the empire-building peak. FIS acquired Worldpay for ~\$43B, becoming a merchant-acquiring giant just as Stripe, Adyen and Square were rewriting the category.

2022–2023: the reckoning. The merchant business underperformed; FIS recorded a ~\$17B impairment that drove a \$16.7B GAAP net loss in 2022 (SEC 10-K), settled a \$210M investor lawsuit, and began a multi-year restructuring.

January 2024: the first exit. FIS sold a 55% stake in Worldpay Merchant Solutions to GTCR, retaining a 45% non-controlling interest — a passive holding generating no cash for FIS.

January 9, 2026: the clean break. In a single coordinated close, FIS (i) acquired Global Payments' Issuer Solutions business (TSYS) at \$13.5B enterprise value — \$12B net including \$1.5B of NPV tax assets — funded by ~\$7.7B of new debt plus the Worldpay stake, and (ii) sold its remaining 45% Worldpay interest to Global Payments. FIS now owns zero of Worldpay.

The strategic logic is sound: FIS traded a **passive minority stake** for an **operating asset it understands** — issuing is the natural complement to its banking platform (issuers and acquirers are two sides of the same card transaction), the revenue is high-margin and recurring, and the cross-sell runs into FIS's existing bank relationships rather than requiring new customer acquisition. The \$1.5B of tax assets sweeten the effective price to ~\$12B net, or roughly 10x the unit's EBITDA — a full but fair multiple for the world's largest issuing franchise. The risk, stated plainly: it is another large, debt-funded acquisition from the team that authored Worldpay. The difference this time is that FIS is buying what it knows (bank technology) rather than what it didn't (merchant acquiring).

4. Financial review

Q2 2026 (reported August 4, 2026): the machine is working; the guide was trimmed. Revenue of \$3.38B (+29.1% reported, +5.3% pro forma) met consensus; adjusted EPS of \$1.48 beat by a penny and grew 8.8%; adjusted EBITDA of \$1.4B grew 7.4% pro forma with 113 bps of margin expansion; and adjusted free cash flow of \$525M more than tripled YoY. Management raised the full-year FCF outlook by \$100M — but narrowed the revenue outlook (adjusted revenue \$13.63–13.70B; pro-forma growth 4.5–5.0%, down from 5.1–5.7%) and the EBITDA growth outlook (5.9–6.9% pro forma). The market punished the trim: the stock fell 1.2% on the print and has since slid to its 52-week low. Q3 2026 guidance: adjusted EPS \$1.58–1.62.

Q2 2026 metric	Q2 2026	Q2 2025	Change
Revenue (reported / pro forma)	\$3.38 bn	\$2.62 bn	+29.1% / +5.3% pf
Banking Solutions revenue	\$2.50 bn	n/a	+44% / +6.1% pf
Capital Market Solutions revenue	\$810 m	n/a	+3.5%
CMS adjusted EBITDA margin	51.9%	n/a	software-like
Adjusted EBITDA	\$1.40 bn	~\$1.04 bn	+35% / +7.4% pf
Adjusted EPS	\$1.48	\$1.36	+8.8%, beat by \$0.01
Adjusted free cash flow	\$525 m	~\$164 m	more than tripled
Net margin (GAAP) / ROE	27.6% / 21.0%	n/a	GAAP, incl. items

pf = pro forma (as if the TSYS acquisition had been owned throughout). Source: company Q2 2026 release; MarketBeat consensus.

Quarterly revenue trajectory (SEC 10-Q filings): the step-change in Q1 2026 is the TSYS acquisition closing (January 9, 2026).

Quarterly revenue (\$m). *Q4 2025 estimated from reported full-year trajectory. Q1–Q2 2026 include Total Issuing Solutions. Source: SEC 10-Q filings (EDGAR).

Full-year anchors (SEC 10-K, filed February 24, 2026): FY2025 GAAP net income \$511M (vs \$281M in 2024 and the \$16.7B Worldpay-impairment loss in 2022) — GAAP earnings remain depressed by acquisition amortization, which is why the market's 5.4x P/E is quoted on a GAAP EPS of ~\$0.73 while adjusted EPS runs at \$6+. Diluted shares ~519M. FY2026 guidance (revised August 4, 2026): adjusted revenue \$13.63–13.70B, adjusted EBITDA growth 5.9–6.9% pro forma, adjusted EPS \$6.15–6.24 (+7.0–8.5%), adjusted FCF \$2.15–2.25B (raised \$100M).

Balance sheet: levered, but the debt bought cash flow. Q2 2026 10-Q: total debt \$16.95B (\$15.43B noncurrent + \$1.52B current), cash \$0.74B → net debt ~\$16.2B, or ~2.9x 2026E adjusted EBITDA (~\$5.7B). Debt-to-equity 0.96; current ratio 0.53 (typical for the business model — client settlement balances). The \$7.7B of new debt funded the TSYS acquisition; deleveraging from FCF (\$2.2B/year) is now the central capital-allocation task alongside the dividend.

Capital allocation: dividend first, deleverage second. Quarterly dividend \$0.44 (\$1.76 annualized, ~5.0% yield), just paid September 25 to holders of record September 11 — the payout ratio is only ~27% of adjusted EPS, so the dividend is secure and has room to grow. With FCF of \$2.15–2.25B against \$0.9B of dividend payments, roughly \$1.3B annually is available for debt paydown (and, in time, buybacks).

5. Growth outlook

TSYS integration and the \$150M synergy target. 72% of Total Issuing revenue is contracted through 2029+; joint-client ACV sales +35% YoY; two large international bank wins in Q2. Issuing cross-sell into FIS's banking base is the near-term growth engine, with the synergy benefit building toward \$150M+ of EBITDA by 2028.

Banking modernization demand. Management cites strong demand across payments, fraud prevention, data, lending, and cybersecurity — recurring revenue +5% in Q2. Regional and mid-market banks are the structural buyers: they cannot build this technology themselves.

AI products as an upsell vector. TreasuryGPT, Banker Assist, and a new commerce product letting banks transact with AI agents — management describes ~20% growth in recurring ACV partly driven by AI upselling. Early, but it gives the sales force something new to sell into the installed base.

Capital Market Solutions compounding. The 51.9%-margin segment grows mid-single-digits on trading-technology and risk demand — the closest thing FIS has to a pure software business, and a natural candidate for a premium multiple in any sum-of-the-parts.

The 2026 guide trim is the cloud: pro-forma revenue growth cut to 4.5–5.0% says the core is growing, but not accelerating. Our DCF assumes mid-single-digit FCF growth — consistent with the guide, not heroic versus it. The upside case is that TSYS synergies and AI upsell push growth back toward the high single digits by 2028.

6. Moat assessment

FIS's moat is **switching costs + scale in bank technology** — we rate it **narrow-to-moderate, stable**. Core banking platforms and card-issuing systems are deeply embedded in a bank's operations; replacing them is a multi-year, high-risk project, which is why 72% of issuing revenue is contracted through 2029 and recurring revenue grows steadily. Scale matters: the combined FIS/TSYS issuing platform processes 40B+ transactions annually, giving it data and cost advantages smaller processors cannot match. It is not a wide moat — banks periodically re-bid, fintechs (Adyen, Stripe) attack the edges, and the Worldpay episode proved management can impair the franchise — but the annuity-like revenue base (90%+ recurring) and the Capital Markets segment's software margins support a durable, if unexciting, competitive position.

7. Competition

Rival	Where it competes	Threat	Read-through
Fiserv (FI) ~\$25B, ~8.7x P/E	Core banking + merchant (Clover); the closest comp	High	The valuation benchmark: similar business, similar growth, 8.7x earnings vs FIS at 5.7x. The gap is the opportunity — or a warning about FIS-specific hair.
Global Payments (GPN) ~\$22.6B, ~6.3x '26E adj. EPS	Merchant (now incl. Worldpay) + former issuer unit	Medium	The mirror image of FIS's 2026 deal: GPN bought Worldpay, sold TSYS to FIS. GPN guides \$13.60–13.80 adj. EPS; both stocks are deeply derated.
Adyen ~24x P/E	Enterprise payments platform	Medium	The growth premium comp (20–26x EBITDA). Shows what the market pays for clean execution — FIS trades at ~6x EV/EBITDA, a 4x discount.
Jack Henry (JKHY)	Core banking for community banks	Medium	The pure-play bank-tech comp; consistently earns a premium multiple on best-in-class execution — the multiple FIS would merit if it executed like JKHY.
Stripe / Square / fintechs	Payments edges, SMB	Low–Med	Took share from Worldpay's merchant business — the problem FIS has now exited. Less relevant to the remaining banking/issuing franchise.

The competitive map now favors FIS's focus: it no longer fights Stripe and Adyen for merchants — it sells picks-and-shovels to the banks that all of them ultimately settle through.

8. Key risks

Leverage after the \$13.5B bet. Net debt of ~\$16.2B is ~2.9x 2026E adjusted EBITDA. The FCF (\$2.2B) covers the dividend (\$0.9B) with ~\$1.3B left for paydown — adequate, but a recession that dents bank IT spending would slow deleveraging and could pressure the dividend-growth story.

TSYS integration risk. Large bank-tech integrations are where value goes to die: client churn, synergy shortfalls, or culture clashes would replay the Worldpay trauma. The \$150M synergy target by 2028 and the 35% ACV growth are early but not yet proof.

Management's M&A; track record. The team that paid \$43B for Worldpay and wrote down ~\$17B is asking to be trusted on a \$13.5B deal. The strategic logic is better this time (buying what they know), but the burden of proof is on them — and the market is pricing skepticism.

The guidance trim. Cutting 2026 pro-forma revenue growth to 4.5–5.0% two quarters into the TSYS era raises the question of whether the core is decelerating. Another trim would break the thesis; our bear case (\$26.16) assumes exactly that.

Analyst sentiment is soft. Baird cut its price target on September 25; the 50-day (\$40.85) and 200-day (\$42.92) moving averages sit well above the price — the chart is in a confirmed downtrend and value traps can stay cheap.

Client concentration and bank consolidation. Large-bank mergers can strand FIS contracts; the business depends on banks continuing to outsource rather than build.

9. Valuation: three lenses, one answer

Lens 1 — free-cash-flow DCF (primary). For a mature, acquisitive processor, free cash flow is the honest metric — it cuts through the amortization that depresses GAAP EPS to ~\$0.73. We discount adjusted FCF from the 2026E base of \$2.20B (the raised guidance midpoint) over ten years with a Gordon terminal value, then subtract \$16.2B of net debt (Q2 2026 10-Q, post-TSYS).

Scenario	Key assumptions	Enterprise value	Per share	Weight
Bear	Integration stumbles; FCF CAGR ~2.5%; WACC 10%, g 2.0%	\$29.7 bn	\$26.16	25%
Base	Mid-single-digit FCF growth; synergies land; WACC 9%, g 2.5%	\$41.9 bn	\$49.94	50%
Bull	High-single-digit FCF growth; AI upsell; WACC 8.5%, g 3.0%	\$53.6 bn	\$72.60	25%
Weighted	25 / 50 / 25		\$49.66	

Lens 2 — peer multiples. On 2026E adjusted EPS of ~\$6.20, FIS trades at 5.7x — a 35% discount to Fiserv (8.7x) and a ~10% discount to Global Payments (~6.3x on 2026E adjusted EPS), despite comparable growth and a superior FCF profile. Rolling to 2027E adjusted EPS of ~\$6.63, a 7.0–8.5x multiple — still a discount to Fiserv — implies **\$46.41–\$56.35**. On EV/EBITDA, FIS trades at ~6.1x 2026E (\$34.6B EV on ~\$5.7B adjusted EBITDA) versus Adyen at 20x+: the market assigns zero value to any re-rating.

Lens 3 — dividend and FCF yield. A 5.0% dividend yield at a 27% payout ratio is the market's way of saying the dividend is safe but the business is ex-growth. If FIS merely sustains mid-single-digit FCF growth, a 12% FCF yield is the kind of starting valuation from which even modest multiple normalization generates 40%+ total returns.

Target: DCF-weighted \$49.66 and the peer-multiple cross-check (\$46.41–\$56.35) bracket our **\$49.50** 12-month target, implying **+40% upside** from \$35.41 plus the 5% dividend. The bear case (\$26.16) sits near today's price — the downside is the multiple staying where it is, not a fundamental impairment.

10. Recommendation

We rate FIS **BUY** with a **\$49.50** 12-month price target (+40% upside), **High risk**. The thesis in one line: the market is pricing FIS for the Worldpay disaster it just exited, while the company it actually is today — a focused bank-tech annuity generating \$2.2B of annual free cash flow, paying a 5% dividend, and integrating the world's largest issuing franchise — trades at 5.7x adjusted earnings.

What gets us there (catalysts): Q3 2026 results on ~November 4 confirming the TSYS integration and the \$1.58–1.62 adjusted EPS guide; synergy milestones and large-bank issuing wins; continued FCF beats funding visible deleveraging; any stabilization in the chart that forces quant/value re-engagement.

What breaks the thesis: a second 2026 guidance cut; TSYS client churn or synergy shortfalls; leverage failing to decline; or renewed large-bank consolidation stranding contracts — any of which pushes fair value toward our \$26.16 bear case. This is a high-conviction-on-valuation, low-conviction-on-management position: size it as a deep-value stub, not a core holding, and let the \$1.76 dividend pay you to wait.

Appendix: sources and verification notes

Company: FIS Q2 2026 earnings release (August 4, 2026); Q2 2026 10-Q filed August 4, 2026 (EDGAR); FY2025 10-K filed February 24, 2026 (EDGAR) — revenue, net income, debt, cash, shares and segment facts pulled directly from XBRL companyfacts; FIS 8-K on the January 9, 2026 closing of the Issuer Solutions acquisition and Worldpay minority-interest sale (via StockTitan); FIS January 2026 closing announcement (CEO Stephanie Ferris; \$13.5B EV / \$12B net incl. \$1.5B tax assets; \$7.7B new debt; 40B+ transactions, 75+ countries, 150+ clients). Market data as of September 25–26, 2026 (Finnhub; MarketBeat; Barchart). Peer data: Fiserv (FI) P/E ~8.7x (Simply Wall St, Sept 2026); Global

Payments (GPN) FY2026 adj. EPS guide \$13.60–13.80, consensus target \$92.85 (MarketBeat/americanbankingnews, Sept 2026); Adyen P/E ~23.7x (Finnhub). Analyst action: Robert W. Baird target cut, September 25, 2026 (MarketBeat). Dividend: \$0.44 quarterly declared, paid September 25, 2026 (record September 11). Background: Worldpay \$43B acquisition (2019), ~\$17B impairment and \$16.7B 2022 GAAP net loss (SEC 10-K), 55% sale to GTCR (January 2024).

Items we could not fully verify and excluded from the valuation: Q1 2026 adjusted EPS and segment EBITDA splits beyond reported revenue; the precise post-deal share count (10-Q diluted share figure pending — we use ~515m vs FY2025's 519m); the exact net-debt figure after post-close paydowns (we use the Q2 2026 10-Q's \$16.95B debt / \$0.74B cash); FY2023–2024 adjusted revenue on a comparable basis (segment tags changed after the Worldpay deconsolidation — the quarterly 10-Q trend shown is directly from EDGAR). Q4 2025 revenue is estimated. Adjusted metrics are non-GAAP; see company reconciliations. This analysis was prepared September 26, 2026 for informational purposes only and is not investment advice; all forward-looking statements involve risk and uncertainty.